`classic_movies`). The `_bulk` API may not be suitable for moving (or migrating) data between indexes. Elasticsearch provides a popular feature: the reindexing (`_reindex`) API. This is discussed in detail in the next section.

5.7 Reindexing documents

Depending on our application and business needs, we may need to move documents from one index to another from time to time. This is especially true when we need to migrate an older index to a newer one due to changes in our mapping schema or settings. We can use the `_reindex` API for such requirements, as this format shows:

```
POST _reindex
{
  "source": {"index": "<source_index>"},
  "dest": {"index": "<destination_index>"}
}
```

When would we put reindexing into action, you may ask? Suppose we want to update our `movies` index with schema modifications that may break the existing index if we implement them directly on it. In this case, the idea is to create a new index with the updated settings (say, a `movies_new` index with the updated schema) and move the data from the old `movies` index to the new one. The query in the following listing does exactly that.

Listing 5.50 Migrating data between indexes using the `_reindex` API

```
POST _reindex
{
  "source": {"index": "movies"},
  "dest": {"index": "movies_new"}
}
```

This query grabs a snapshot of the `movies` index and pushes the records into the new index. Data is migrated between these indexes as expected.

One of the important use cases of reindexing is zero-downtime migration in production if we use this approach with aliases. We go over this in chapter 6.

This has been a long chapter, and we've covered a lot. Let's wrap it up and jump to the next chapter, where we discuss indexing operations in detail.

Summary

- Elasticsearch provides a set of APIs that work on documents. We can use these APIs to execute CRUD actions (create, read, update, and delete) on individual documents.
- Our documents are held in the shard's in-memory buffer and pushed into a segment during the refresh process. Lucene employs a strategy of creating a new segment with the documents during the refresh. It then cumulatively merges three segments to form a new segment, and the process repeats.